INT. APARTMENT - NIGHT

Two girls sit at a table, studying.

CASS (21) sits hunched over, staring at an index card.

Across from her, CHLOE (21) types fast and focused on her laptop.

Cass closes her eyes, takes a slow breath, and opens them. Stares at the same card.

Chloe keeps typing, not looking up.

CHLOE
You’re gonna tear the card.

CASS
Shut up.

CHLOE
Just saying.

Cass sighs.

Chloe’s typing slows, then pauses. She looks over the top of her laptop.

CHLOE (cont'd)
Cass?
You okay bud?

Cass looks up.

CASS
Do I look okay?

Cass pulls her knees up to her chest.

CHLOE
No comment.

Cass throws the card down on to the pile that flops over.

CASS
I’m just gonna choke! Vance is gonna ask one question and I’ll blank.

Cass drops her head to the table with a THUD.

CHLOE
Cass.

CASS
(muffled)
Shut up.

CHLOE
Rude. I just want to make sure my buddy is fine.

CASS
(muffled)
I'm fine!

Cass tilts her head to lay on her chin a little to look at Chloe.

CHLOE
Yeah? Because, you've been on the third bullet point since nine o'clock.

Cass snaps her head up. Her eyes are rimmed red.

CASS
Because Vance could ask the third bullet point! He could ask the spiritual meaning behind any of these bullet points! Then, he will look over those stupid glasses! And-I-I might forget my own social security number.

CHLOE
Don't be silly.

Chloe flicks her wrist, reaches across the table and taps the note cards.

CHLOE (cont'd)
You have the material.

CASS
Yeah but what good does that do? YOU know it! I just have your outline, big difference!

Chloe tilts her head.

CHLOE
What does that mean?

Chloe spins a ring on her middle finger.

CASS
It means! When you talk, it sounds like you built the theory yourself! When I talk, it sounds like I am reading like-a ransom note! I have your knowledge on paper! Sure, but I am still Cassidy Brown!

Chloe looks at Cass's hands. Then Chloe looks at her own hand, see the silver ring.

CHLOE
You don't need to be me.

CASS
I sure hope not, but I am just saying, it would help.

Chloe slides the ring off.

CHLOE
You just need this.

She reaches across the table, takes Cass's wrist, and drops the ring into her open palm.

CASS
(sarcastic)
Oh? You have a magical-

Cass looks at the metal, then up at Chloe.

CASS (cont'd)
No. Chlo, that's your ring,

CHLOE
Yeah, put it on. Give it back after your Q&A tomorrow, okay?

Cass hesitates before sliding the band onto her index finger. It's warm from Chloe's skin.

Cass turns her hand over, feeling the weight of it.

CASS
Are you sure? Like-seriously. If I drop it down the heating vent I'll literally jump out the window!

Chloe types, ignoring her.

CASS (cont'd)
Thank you.

CHLOE
(chuckles)
Shut up.

Cass swallows and does a small nod.

CASS
Okay.

Cass flips through her index cards with a pursed lip.

Chloe looks up.

CHLOE
Cass, don't-

CASS
(holding back tears)
I won't.

Chloe rolls her eyes and fights away a smile.

A single tear rolls down her face.

CHLOE
Cass, its okay.

Cass looks up at her.

CASS
I mean, you say that. But, you dad-

Chloe sighs.

CHLOE
I know. But he would want me to share his love.

CASS
He did have a lot of it.

Chloe nods.

CHLOE
He had a big heart, yes.

Cass goes back to the note cards again.

The girls fall into comfort again.

CASS
I think about him.

CHLOE
Me too Cass. Me too.

They smile.

CASS
He would be proud.

Chloe looks up with a half smile.

CHLOE
He would be proud of both of us Cass.
He loved you too. Called you his 4th.

Cass smiles.

FADE OUT

The main changes and feedback that I got was that they wanted a reason for the ring. I wanted to add something, say it without actually saying a lot of details. I think that it might read kinda simple now. But I think that with another revision, I could polish it even more. I also got comments about the dialogue seeming to flat, so I made them have more direction.

As for the whys, I think the direction I went wast exactly a new one. It was a continuation of what I had previously. I think I just wanted to make it clear the stakes of this ring. I that I did that without hitting it on the nail too much.